

Light sources spontaneously not working in some chunks

MC-142134 Lighting

Status	Resolved / Fixed
Affected	Minecraft 19w02a, Minecraft 19w03a, Minecraft 19w03b, Minecraft 19w03c, Minecraft 19w04b, Minecraft 19w05a (+19 more)
Fixed in	Minecraft 1.14 Pre-Release 3, Minecraft 1.14.2 Pre-Release 3
Reported	2019-01-11

STEPS TO REPRODUCE

1. Launch Minecraft and open the affected singleplayer world from a backup made immediately before the issue can be triggered.
2. Restore the backup.
3. Select the restored world and choose Edit.
4. Choose Optimize world.
5. Enable the "erase cache data" option before loading the world.
6. Choose Backup and Load.
7. Observe that the stairway or other affected areas, potentially including entire chunks from the surface to bedrock, are pitch black; torches, lanterns, and jack-o-lanterns in those areas do not function, allowing monsters to spawn and causing underground crops to break.

OBSERVED BEHAVIOUR

Actual behavior

After returning to an existing world, some chunks spontaneously lose the effective light from previously placed light-emitting blocks. Affected areas can encompass entire chunks from the surface down to bedrock, including structures that were previously lit.

Torches, lanterns, and jack-o-lanterns remain placed but no longer illuminate their surroundings. The affected areas therefore become dark enough for hostile mobs to spawn, and underground crops can break because they no longer receive sufficient light. This is not limited to the client's rendering: the lighting state used by the game is also affected.

The lighting can be restored by forcing each affected light source to update, such as by removing and replacing it. Updating or replacing the sources individually is currently the only in-game recovery method reported.

EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR

Light sources such as torches, lanterns, and jack-o-lanterns should continue emitting light normally in every affected chunk, from the surface through underground areas, without requiring replacement or updates. The affected areas should remain properly illuminated, preventing hostile mobs from spawning due to missing light and allowing underground crops to grow normally. This behavior should persist after loading or optimizing the world.

ENVIRONMENT

Minecraft Java Edition Versions: 19w02a, 19w03a, 19w03b, 19w03c, 19w04b, 19w05a, 19w06a, 19w07a, 19w08b, 19w09a, 19w11a, 19w12a, 19w12b, 19w13a, 19w13b, 19w14a, 19w14b, 1.14 Pre-Release 1, 1.14 Pre-Release 2, 1.14 Pre-Release 5, 1.14, 1.14.1 Pre-Release 1, 1.14.1 Pre-Release 2, 1.14.1, 1.14.2 Pre-Release 2 (includes snapshots)

ORIGINAL DESCRIPTION

Moderator Notice

In order to fix your existing world, you can try following these steps. Apparently this is just a temporary workaround, so you might need to repeat this once the issue reoccurs again.

Singleplayer: Select world → Edit world → Optimize world → check "erase cache data" → Backup and load

Multiplayer: Start the server.jar with the following command:

```
java -jar server.jar --forceUpgrade --eraseCache
```

This only needs to be done once, after this you can start your world or the server the usual way again.

Minecraft Realms: Download the world from your realm, copy it into your Minecraft singleplayer worlds folder, follow the steps for singleplayer, and then upload the world back up to your realm.

Please read

If this is still happening to you, and if you have a backup of the world right before you can trigger the issue, that might help; I managed to get one and consistently reproduce it, and fixed what was causing it, but there might be more to it; if you can reproduce it by

- Restoring the backup
- Choosing edit -> optimize -> erase cached data (before loading it)
- See the issue immediately after loading the world

Then it would be very helpful if you can share your world backup, along with what render distance you're using.

Thanks!

- fry in this comment

I found a stairway I'd previously made now pitch black.

I later found other areas (entire chunks, surface to bedrock) showing this behavior as well.

This is not just a visual glitch - the light sources I've used (torch, lantern, and jack-o-lantern) are all nonfunctional. As a result, monsters will spawn in them, and underground crops in these areas will break.

Forcing every single light source to update (or outright replacing them) is the only way I've found to get them to visually working again.

MANUAL RESULT

Version used	
Reproduced?	YES / NO / PARTIAL
Crash file	
Notes	
Tested by / date	

Live issue: <https://bugs.mojang.com/browse/MC/issues/MC-142134>